

Chapter 162-2

Thinking of that dream, Zhao Xuning dialed the number she had memorized for so long with trembling hands. There was a long series of dial tones...

Just when it was about to automatically disconnect, the call was answered. A slightly hoarse voice with a hint of crying said: "Hello?"

"Why are you crying?" Zhao Xuning's palms were sweating.

The other end of the phone suddenly went quiet. After a moment, a guarded voice came: "What does it have to do with you?"

"Shen Hui." Zhao Xuning closed her eyes, and tears fell onto her pillow. "I... I'm sorry."

Shen Hui paused.

Hearing those three words, she felt somewhat dazed.

Even when they were dating, she could count on one hand the number of times she'd heard Zhao Xuning say those words.

Even later when she had her miscarriage, she had never heard her say a single "I'm sorry."

Zhao Xuning's expressions and eyes had always said sorry, but she just never spoke the words aloud.

Suddenly hearing these words now, Shen Hui was stunned, her mind going completely blank.

After a long while, she finally found her voice again: "Zhao Xuning... don't you think it's too late?"

"I dreamed of..." Zhao Xuning's voice was choked. "Our little one."

"And also." Zhao Xuning let out a soft breath. "Ah Hui, I miss you so much."

The moment those words fell, the call was disconnected.

Zhao Xuning turned her phone face down and buried her head in her pillow.

She didn't make any sound, but the pillow became wet.

On the other side of the city, Shen Hui, who had hung up the phone, sat up in bed and suddenly burst into loud sobs.

In the empty, silent house, her crying echoed continuously.

So many things... seemed to always arrive too late.

The apology she wanted from Zhao Xuning, the yielding and bowing of head she wanted from Zhao Xuning.

She hadn't dreamed of their little one in such a long, long time.

//

When Liang Shi went out, she brought pepper spray and waited downstairs for her agent on time.

As they went upstairs together, the agent reminded her: "If it's normal business discussion, we'll talk. Otherwise... there's no need. I'll be with you."

This was like giving Liang Shi a shot of confidence.

Seeing Liang Shi look at her in shock, the agent laughed: "What? Did you think I would just sell you out?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "No..."

"I'm here to help artists film," the agent said disdainfully. "Not to be a pimp."

Liang Shi: "....."

Blunt, but reassuring.

"Our company doesn't have that kind of culture," the agent said. "Ability comes first."

Liang Shi nodded: "Looks like I joined the right company."

The two went upstairs and walked toward the appointed location.

For some reason, the more Liang Shi walked, the more nervous she felt.

She had clearly seen big occasions before, navigating between major platforms, meeting plenty of investors, and being able to chat and laugh with them.

This wasn't supposed to be difficult for her.

But today her heart kept pounding, as if something big was about to happen.

Before entering, the agent reminded Liang Shi: "Be well-mannered. It would be best if you could fool her."

Liang Shi: ".....Okay."

"Knock knock—"

The agent raised her hand and knocked on the door. Someone opened it, nodded to Liang Shi and her agent, then left carrying some documents.

In the CEO's office, someone was nestled in a large chair, but with their back to them. The chair was too big to see clearly.

All they could see was that it was a woman with very long hair, very thin.

Liang Shi vaguely caught sight of the hair tips and thought they looked somewhat similar to Xu Qingzhu's.

The agent spoke from the side: "Hello, I'm Chang Hui from Huayi's talent management department, and I'm also Liang Shi's agent."

Her attitude was very good.

The other person raised a hand. "You go out first."

The voice was very cold.

Liang Shi found it somewhat familiar.

Hearing this, the agent frowned. "Um... business matters are usually handled by the agent. If there's anything, it would be better if you told me..."

Before the word "better" could finish leaving her mouth, the chair turned around, and that beautiful face with sharp, defined features appeared before the two of them.

Xu Qingzhu was wearing a light lotus-root colored suit with a white shirt underneath. Her entire body was buried in that large CEO chair, making her appear even more frail and petite.

Yet her presence was not to be underestimated.

Those eyes lifted slightly, carrying a hint of indifference.

Even after seeing Liang Shi, her expression didn't change. She just casually glanced at her, then looked away, as if Liang Shi was just someone completely unrelated to her.

The realization brought by that look made Liang Shi's heart suddenly ache.

She stared unblinkingly at Xu Qingzhu.

Xu Qingzhu had gotten thinner again.

Before, this suit had fit her perfectly. Now it was slightly too big.

Xu Qingzhu casually picked up a pen from the desk. The pen seemed to come alive in her hands, spinning idly. Her face still wore that indifferent expression.

The office fell into silence.